

COVENANT OF INK AND DUE RECORD CONCERNING HALVARD SABLEWOOD

Let this instrument be read before witnesses, *seal-bearers*, and all who have cause to trust the written word.

The person called Halvard Sablewood, a minor figure of the Ashen Era, is hereby received into the keeping of the undersigned house, office, or claimant, whose name may be entered beside the seal when this covenant is witnessed. This covenant concerns the faithful exercise of his craft and shall be judged by the marks he makes, not by rumor, appearance, or temper.

It is entered into the record that Halvard Sablewood was born in 408 AS. It is further entered that he serves as a scribe. His hand, therefore, shall be lent to the setting down of testimony, inventories, oaths, accounts, petitions, condemnations, pardons, and such other matter as is placed before him under lawful instruction.

He shall preserve the meaning of every dictated word. Where a passage is broken, doubtful, sealed, or beyond his authority to amend, he shall mark the defect rather than conceal it. He shall not alter a name, measure, debt, boundary, confession, or judgment for favor, fear, hunger, payment, or threat. If commanded to make a copy, he shall distinguish copy from original. If commanded to destroy a record, he shall seek the command in writing before applying blade, flame, water, or ash.

All leaves, scraps, tablets, bindings, seals, pigments, and instruments entrusted to his care shall remain the property of the party that entrusted them, unless another disposition is written upon this covenant. A record completed by his hand shall not be removed, hidden, exchanged, or shown to an unpermitted reader without leave from the authority that commissioned it.

No description of Halvard Sablewood's physical appearance is preserved in the canonical record; accordingly, no bodily likeness, portrait, or identifying mark shall be demanded as proof of his service. His visual identity is associated with the work of a scribe. His canonical temperament is unrecorded, and no claim of cheer, cruelty, loyalty, treachery, patience, or wrath shall be entered against him merely because silence leaves room for invention.

The undersigned accepts the written labor of Halvard Sablewood only

as far as each page bears its proper acknowledgment. He accepts no
erased bargain, whispered amendment, or unsigned accusation as a
lawful alteration of this covenant.

May the ink endure where flesh fails.

For the commissioning hand: _____

For Halvard Sablewood: _____

Witnessing seal or mark: _____